MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 12

"This Christmas"

Episode 2x12. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x12 (the Christmas episode). Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Thursday, December 22, 2005 (day three of the TWU transit strike), 5:12 AM through 11:56 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 40 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x11

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Thursday, December 22, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Thursday, December 22, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Howard Divine	Harmony's father; TWU Local 100 bus operator (on strike)	Aug 30, 1950	55
Lillian Divine	Harmony's mother	Feb 14, 1952	53
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	26
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern (on probation)	Jun 11, 1978	27
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (33 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Earl Peebles (new)	Patient: 14-foot roof fall, splenic laceration	Nov 30, 1947	58
Dorothy Peebles (new)	Earl's wife	Jun 18, 1949	56
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Lady Bernadine Starks (new)	Patient: bleeding duodenal ulcer, gospel recording artist	Mar 8, 1956	49
Freddie Lyle (new)	Bernadine's manager	Jul 7, 1953	52
Brother Oliver Pettway (new)	Bernadine's choir director	Oct 2, 1961	44
Yvonne Starks (new)	Bernadine's sister	Apr 11, 1960	45
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Kamari Fields (new)	Patient: failing Fontan, heart transplant	Apr 24, 1991	14
Nadine Fields (new)	Kamari's mother; MTA station agent (on strike)	Aug 1, 1967	38
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Quentin Bascomb (new)	Patient: cyclist, epidural hematoma	Jan 29, 1974	31
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	26
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	Patient: Status 1A, awaiting a heart	Aug 8, 1971	34
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Cedric Hall	Architect; Monty's partner	Jan 22, 1965	40
Tamika Wardell	Mother of the Wardell quintuplets	Sep 14, 1974	31
Andre Wardell	Tamika's husband	Mar 27, 1972	33

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Isaiah Crump	Chief of Pediatric Surgery	Mar 11, 1944	61
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	OB/GYN and Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Lorna Ellison (on-screen debut)	Raven's mother	Mar 14, 1961	44
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
Augustin Toussaint	Camille's father	Feb 9, 1941	64
Mercy	The House's pit bull puppy (about 12 weeks)	Sep 30, 2005	0

Also appearing: TWU picketers, Tamiko (Bernadine's stylist), EMTs, a CT radiologist, an anesthesiologist, an organ procurement coordinator, a helicopter crew, Laurelton neighbors, a St. Albans church bus, a Salvation Army bell ringer, Amtrak passengers, and the four Wardell quintuplets. Mentioned: Dr. Sylvia Rountree, Roger Toussaint, Judge Theodore Jones, Mayor Bloomberg, Victor Donohue, Dr. Joan Mercer, Cornelius Fairbanks, Malcolm Sloan and Raven's late grandmother.

COLD OPEN

1 EXT. MTA QUEENS VILLAGE DEPOT - PICKET LINE - PRE-DAWN
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 5:12 AM

Bitter cold. A barrel fire. Thirty bus operators in TWU Local 100 jackets walk a slow oval outside the shuttered depot gates, carrying signs: "TWU LOCAL 100 ON STRIKE," "RESPECT US, PROTECT US, PAY US," "PENSIONS ARE NOT A GIFT." Howard Divine (55), in a knit cap and an MTA parka, walks with them, coughing into his glove.

A Ford Econoline van pulls up. Lillian Divine (53), in her church hat over a ski cap, slides open the side door. Steam pours out: three urns of coffee and a tray of foil-wrapped egg sandwiches.

LILLIAN
(calling out)
Day three, gentlemen! (beat) Nobody pickets on an empty stomach!

A cheer from the line. Howard comes over, kisses his wife, and takes a coffee in both hands.

HOWARD
(beat)
Taylor Law, Lil. (beat) Two days' pay for every day we're out. (beat) Judge Jones fined the union a million dollars a day.

LILLIAN
(handing him a sandwich)
I know what it costs, Howard. (beat) Eat.

MARC (V.O.)
Christmas in New York is supposed to be a postcard.

2 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - LIVING ROOM - PRE-DAWN
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 5:31 AM

The living room has been transformed. Garland on every banister. A wreath on every door. Three strands of lights around the bay window. And in the corner, an eight-foot Fraser fir, bare, in a stand, surrounded by eleven boxes of ornaments. Raven (26), in a Santa hat and pajamas, untangles a strand of lights on the floor at warp speed. Mercy, the puppy, now twelve weeks old in her too-big red collar, chews a candy cane.

Marc (26), in a robe, stands in the doorway, staring.

MARC
(beat)
Rave. (beat) When did you do this?

RAVEN
(not looking up)
Between two and five. (beat) I couldn't sleep.

MARC
(beat)
Because of tonight.

RAVEN
(untangling faster)
Because of tonight. (beat) My mother's train gets into Penn Station at seven fifty-two. (beat) She hasn't seen me since I was twenty. (beat) The house has to look like a person lives here who's okay.

MARC (V.O.)
But a postcard is only the outside of something.

Marc sits down on the floor beside her and takes the other end of the tangled strand.

MARC
(beat)
You are okay.

RAVEN
(beat, finally stopping)
I'm putting up eleven boxes of ornaments at five in the morning, Marc.

MARC (V.O.)
Nobody ever photographs what it costs to make it look that way.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 EXT. PULASKI BRIDGE - DAWN
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 6:18 AM

A river of people on foot crossing the Pulaski Bridge from Greenpoint into Queens: nurses in sneakers, office workers in suits with briefcases, a man on a unicycle. Breath steaming. Among them, walking briskly with a tote bag: Esther (26), with Kennerly (27), who walks his bicycle beside her.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Three days. (beat) Two hours each way. (beat) I biked from Carroll Gardens. (beat) My thighs have filed a grievance.

ESTHER
(beat)
The F to Jay Street was supposed to be my Christmas present to myself.

KENNERLY
(beat)
You going home? Boston?

ESTHER
(beat)
Tomorrow. (beat) Amtrak runs. (beat) Clayton and me. (beat) Christmas Eve in Mattapan.

KENNERLY
(beat)
With your whole family.

ESTHER
(beat)
With my whole family. (beat) And a man I haven't spoken to in ten months.

Kennerly glances at her. He doesn't ask. For once in his life, he doesn't ask.

KENNERLY
(beat)
I'm working through Christmas. (beat) Holiday pay. (beat) My father's in Scottsdale with his third wife. (beat) She's twenty-nine.

ESTHER
(beat)
Merry Christmas, Kennerly.

KENNERLY
(beat, wry)
Merry Christmas, Smilley. (beat) Don't let them ruin it.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 6:58 AM

A strike-day skeleton crew. A Christmas tree made of IV poles and green surgical towels stands at the nurses' station, topped with a rubber glove star. Elxa (28), thirty-three weeks pregnant, sits on her stool with her feet on two glove boxes. The interns gather: Marc, Raven, Harmony, Amond, Arianna, Esther, Kennerly.

ELXA
Day three of the strike. (beat) Twenty-two nurses are sleeping in the hospital. (beat) Half the residents walked over a bridge. (beat) Dr. Rountree has paid for a fleet of vans out of the CEO's discretionary fund, and they will pick you up in carpools of four. (beat) If you are not in a carpool of four, you are walking.

ELXA
(reading off)
Ellison: Lowery, a roof fall coming in from Laurelton. (beat) Divine: Lowery's GI bleed. (beat) Baker: Cardio, the pediatric transplant consult. Dr. Robert Bullock wants you. (beat) Cummings: Crump, the quints. (beat) Smilley, Bullock: Graves, then the ER. (beat) Kennerly: ER.

The interns move. Elxa catches Amond's sleeve.

ELXA
(beat)
Baker. (beat) Grand Rounds. The twentieth. (beat) I heard you made Whitlow's chief resident cry.

AMOND
(beat)
I read Ms. Tate-Moore's triage note aloud. (beat) Word for word. (beat) "Patient takes digoxin at home per daughter." (beat) Then I asked forty-one residents to stand up if they'd ever seen a home medication form in their admission packet. (beat) Nobody stood up.

ELXA
(beat)
And Whitlow?

AMOND
(beat)
He said, "Thank you, Dr. Baker." (beat) Then he walked out before the questions.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - TRAUMA 1 - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 7:21 AM

EARL PEEBLES (58), a big, jolly man in a Santa sweatshirt over long johns, lies on a backboard in a cervical collar, a Christmas light strand still wrapped around one ankle. His wife DOROTHY (56), in curlers under a scarf, holds his hand. Lowery (58) and Raven examine him. Gloria (53) runs the bay.

DOROTHY
(frantic)
Fourteen feet. (beat) Off the roof. (beat) At six in the morning. (beat) In the dark. (beat) Because the reindeer on the left was "crooked."

EARL
(through the collar, wincing)
It was crooked, Dot. (beat) Forty-one thousand lights. (beat) Twenty-two years. (beat) The Laurelton Christmas House. (beat) People drive from Jersey.

RAVEN
(pressing gently on his left upper abdomen)
Mr. Peebles, does this hurt?

EARL
(yelping)
Like a sleigh ran over me.

RAVEN
(to Lowery)
Left upper quadrant tenderness, left lower rib pain. (beat) Pressure one-oh-two over sixty. Heart rate one-ten. (beat) Spleen.

LOWERY
(beat)
FAST.

Raven runs the ultrasound probe over his belly. On the screen, a black stripe of fluid surrounds the spleen.

RAVEN
(beat)
Free fluid in Morison's pouch and around the spleen. (beat) CT if he stays stable.

EARL
(beat, worried)
Doc, I've got to be home by tonight. (beat) The lights go on at five. Every night. (beat) There's a church bus from St. Albans coming at seven.

LOWERY
(gently)
Mr. Peebles, you have a bleeding spleen. (beat) You're not going to be on a roof tonight.

EARL
(beat, to Raven, pleading)
Then somebody's got to plug it in.

Raven looks at the big man in the Santa sweatshirt with a light strand around his ankle. Something in his face looks exactly like her at five that morning.

RAVEN
(beat)
We'll figure it out, Mr. Peebles.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - VIP SUITE - 8 WEST - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 7:46 AM

A private room crowded with people. In the bed: LADY BERNADINE STARKS (49), a gospel superstar in a satin bed jacket, gold rings on every finger, pale under her makeup. Around her: her manager, FREDDIE LYLE (52), with two cell phones; her stylist, TAMIKO, with a garment bag; her choir director, BROTHER OLIVER PETTWAY (44), with sheet music; and her sister, YVONNE STARKS (45), with a Bible. Harmony stands at the foot of the bed with the chart. Lowery reviews labs.

FREDDIE
(into a phone)
No, she's doing the Apollo Christmas special on the twenty-third. (beat) No, she's fine. (beat) It's a stomach thing.

LOWERY
(to the room, firmly)
It's a bleeding ulcer. (beat) She vomited blood twice last night. Her hemoglobin is eight-point-one. (beat) She's had an endoscopy, and the bleeding vessel was clipped. (beat) She needs rest. Bland food. A proton pump inhibitor. No aspirin. No stress.

TAMIKO
(unzipping the garment bag)
She's going to want to see the dress for the twenty-third.

BERNADINE
(weak, regal)
Let me see the dress, baby.

HARMONY
(beat, carefully)
Lady Starks. (beat) When did the stomach pain start?

BERNADINE
(beat)
October. (beat) The tour. Forty-one cities in fifty days. (beat) Freddie booked the Apollo the day after we came home.

FREDDIE
(covering the phone)
It's the Apollo, Bernie.

YVONNE
(opening the Bible)
She's been taking Goody's powders like candy. For the headaches. (beat) Four a day.

LOWERY
(beat, to Harmony)
Aspirin. (beat) Stress. (beat) And an H. pylori test pending. (beat) Dr. Divine. (beat) Your job today is to keep that woman's stomach quiet.

HARMONY
(beat)
Yes, sir.

Lowery leaves. Freddie's second phone rings. Oliver hums a melody under his breath and starts writing on the sheet music. Tamiko holds up a sequined gown. Bernadine's face is gray.

HARMONY
(beat, to herself)
Quiet.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PEDIATRIC CARDIOLOGY - ROOM 5 - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 8:12 AM

KAMARI FIELDS (14), skinny, with headphones around his neck, lies in bed playing a Game Boy. His lips are faintly blue. His mother, NADINE FIELDS (38), an MTA station agent on day three of the strike, sits beside him knitting. Robert (49) and Amond stand at the bedside. On the wall: a hand-drawn calendar with thirty-one days crossed out.

ROBERT
(gently)
Kamari. (beat) A donor heart has been offered for you. (beat) It's coming from Pennsylvania. It will be here by early afternoon.

Nadine's knitting needles stop.

NADINE
(whispering)
Oh, God. (beat) Oh, thank you, Jesus.

KAMARI
(not looking up from the Game Boy)
No.

Silence.

AMOND
(beat)
Kamari...

KAMARI
(beat, still playing)
I said no. (beat) I don't want it.

NADINE
(beat)
Baby, what are you talking about?

KAMARI
(finally looking up)
I had a Fontan when I was four. (beat) I've had six surgeries. (beat) I've been in a hospital every Christmas since I was nine. (beat) Somebody died for that heart. (beat) And then I take the pills for the rest of my life, and I get rejection and cancer and kidney failure, and I'm back here. (beat) I looked it up. (beat) I don't want it.

Nadine starts crying. Robert and Amond look at each other.

ROBERT
(beat, quietly)
Dr. Baker. Outside.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PEDIATRIC CARDIOLOGY - CORRIDOR - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 8:21 AM

Robert and Amond by the window at the end of the hall. A paper snowflake is taped to the glass.

AMOND
(low, intense)
He's fourteen. (beat) His mother is his legal guardian, and she'll sign the consent in a heartbeat. (beat) That's enough. Legally, ethically, that's enough.

ROBERT
(beat)
Legally.

AMOND
Sir, a failing Fontan at fourteen. (beat) Without a heart, he has months. (beat) Maybe until spring.

ROBERT
(beat)
And with a heart he doesn't want, Dr. Baker, he has a lifetime of immunosuppressants twice a day. (beat) Every day. Forever. (beat) Do you know the number one cause of graft loss in adolescent transplant recipients?

AMOND
(beat)
Nonadherence.

ROBERT
(beat)
A teenager who doesn't want the heart stops taking the pills. (beat) He rejects it at seventeen, and somebody else's child died for nothing. (beat) The heart doesn't care what the consent form says. (beat) It only works in somebody who's willing to live with it.

AMOND
(beat)
So we let him die because he's fourteen and scared?

ROBERT
(beat)
We don't let him do anything. (beat) We have five hours before that heart is too old to use. (beat) Ethics consult. Psychology. Child life. (beat) And we listen to him.

AMOND
(beat, sharp)
And if listening takes six hours?

ROBERT
(beat, evenly)
Then the heart goes to the next child on the list. (beat) And we will have done the hardest thing in this job, which is not getting our way.

Amond stares at him. Robert holds his gaze.

AMOND
(beat)
With respect, sir. (beat) My father bled out holding my hand because nobody got there fast enough. (beat) I don't do slow.

ROBERT
(beat, quietly)
I know you don't, Amond. (beat) That's why I need you in that room.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - TRAUMA 2 - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 8:47 AM

QUENTIN BASCOMB (31), a Wall Street analyst in a torn Brooks Brothers suit, a bike helmet cracked down the middle on the gurney beside him, mumbles, confused. Blood in his hair. EMTs, Marc and Esther. Gloria at the monitor.

EMT
Cyclist versus a cab on Queens Plaza. (beat) He bought the bike Tuesday morning at a Sports Authority because of the strike. (beat) He's ridden it four times. (beat) GCS fourteen at the scene, twelve now.

MARC
(shining a penlight)
Mr. Bascomb. Can you hear me?

QUENTIN
(slurring)
I have a... (beat) I have a nine o'clock.

ESTHER
(watching his pupils)
Left pupil's sluggish. (beat) Right-sided weakness.

MARC
(beat)
Lucid interval at the scene. (beat) Now he's declining.

ESTHER
(beat)
Epidural. (beat) Page Graves. (beat) Head CT, now.

QUENTIN
(beat, drifting)
The helmet was forty dollars. (beat) The guy said it was the good one.

MARC
(gently)
It was the good one, Mr. Bascomb. (beat) It's why you're still talking.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - VIP SUITE - 8 WEST - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 9:06 AM

The suite is louder than before. Freddie is on two phones. Tamiko is steaming the gown with a handheld steamer. Brother Oliver plays a keyboard on a rolling tray table. Yvonne reads a psalm aloud over all of it. Bernadine lies in bed, a hand on her stomach. Harmony comes in with the morning labs.

HARMONY
(raising her voice)
Excuse me. (beat) Excuse me!

Everyone stops.

HARMONY
(beat)
Lady Starks's hemoglobin is seven-point-eight. (beat) It was eight-one last night. (beat) That means she's still bleeding a little. (beat) I need this room quiet. (beat) That means one visitor. No phones. No keyboard. No steamer.

FREDDIE
(beat, condescending)
Sweetheart. (beat) Do you know who you're talking to?

HARMONY
(beat)
Yes, sir. (beat) My patient. (beat) And you are?

FREDDIE
(beat)
Freddie Lyle. (beat) Twenty-two years. Four Grammys. Stellar Awards, eleven of them. (beat) The Apollo is tomorrow night. (beat) She's singing "O Holy Night" live for a television audience of four million people.

HARMONY
(beat)
Her stomach doesn't watch television, Mr. Lyle.

A beat. Bernadine laughs weakly from the bed, then winces.

BERNADINE
(beat, tired)
Freddie. (beat) The girl's right.

FREDDIE
Bernie, the producers...

BERNADINE
(beat)
Give me an hour, Freddie. (beat) One hour.

Freddie looks at Harmony with naked dislike. Then he herds the others out. Yvonne stays, with her Bible. Harmony exhales.

BERNADINE
(eyes closed)
You sing, baby?

HARMONY
(startled)
How did you know?

BERNADINE
(beat)
You said "quiet" like a choir director. (beat) From the diaphragm.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - RADIOLOGY - CT READING ROOM - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 9:32 AM

Lowery and Raven behind the radiologist. On the screen: Earl's spleen, cracked by a dark jagged line through its middle, surrounded by blood.

RADIOLOGIST
Grade three splenic laceration. (beat) Moderate hemoperitoneum. (beat) No active contrast blush.

LOWERY
(beat)
He's stable. (beat) No blush. (beat) Dr. Ellison?

RAVEN
(beat)
Nonoperative management. (beat) ICU, serial hemoglobins every six hours, strict bed rest. (beat) If he becomes unstable or drops his crit, he goes to the OR.

LOWERY
(beat)
And if he tries to get up and go home to plug in forty-one thousand Christmas lights?

RAVEN
(beat)
Then he ruptures his spleen on his front lawn in front of a church bus.

LOWERY
(beat, almost smiling)
Go tell him that.

RAVEN
(beat)
Dr. Lowery. (beat) The lights go on at five o'clock. (beat) Somebody has to plug them in.

LOWERY
(beat)
Somebody isn't on your intern job description, Dr. Ellison. (beat) And you've got a train to meet at seven-fifty-two.

Raven stops.

RAVEN
(beat)
How do you know about the train?

LOWERY
(beat, walking out)
Dr. Ellison. (beat) Your whole service knows about the train.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 9:51 AM

The four Wardell isolettes. Each has a tiny red felt stocking taped to the side, embroidered in glitter glue: AALIYAH, ANDRE JR., BRIELLE, DEVIN. Arianna writes notes at the window. Raven comes in, still holding Earl's films.

ARIANNA
(not looking up)
Thirteen days until my score. (beat) I'm not thinking about it. (beat) The NICU nurses made stockings. (beat) I'm thinking about the stockings.

RAVEN
(beat)
Tonight. (beat) Penn Station. (beat) Seven fifty-two.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I know.

RAVEN
(beat)
I want you there.

Arianna puts her pen down.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Raven. (beat) That's your mother. (beat) Six years. (beat) You don't need a girl from Pittsburgh standing behind you on the platform.

RAVEN
(beat)
Where are you spending Christmas?

ARIANNA
(beat, shrugging)
Here. (beat) Double shift. (beat) My mother doesn't know what day it is. (beat) My father's somewhere in Allegheny County, hopefully alive.

RAVEN
(beat)
Then come to the station. (beat) Please. (beat) I don't want to see her for the first time without somebody there who knows me.

Arianna looks at her for a long moment. Then she nods, once.

ARIANNA
(beat, gruff)
Fine. (beat) But I'm not hugging anybody.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 10:14 AM

Dash, his line-up still sharp, sits up in bed in his Carolina blue hoodie with a cup of Jell-O. A cardboard Christmas tree from the gift shop sits on his tray table. Raven comes in for vitals.

DASH
(beat)
Is it true? (beat) The kid on four? (beat) A heart came in and he said no?

RAVEN
(startled)
How...

DASH
(beat)
Doctor, I've been on this floor for seven weeks. (beat) The night nurses tell me everything. (beat) Fourteen years old. A heart. And he said no.

RAVEN
(beat)
He's had six surgeries. (beat)
He's scared.

Dash sets down the Jell-O. He's quiet for a long beat.

DASH
(beat)
I've been 1A for six weeks.
(beat) I know my blood type, my
body weight and the exact number
of steps from this bed to that
window. (beat) Fourteen. (beat)
I'd give my last store for that
call. (beat) Let me talk to him.

RAVEN
(beat)
Dash, you're on a milrinone drip.

DASH
(grinning)
So put me in a wheelchair and
hang the drip on it. (beat) I've
seen you do it.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - MORNING
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 10:39 AM

Natasha at the window. A small TV on the credenza plays NY1 with the sound low: "TWU EXECUTIVE BOARD TO MEET THIS AFTERNOON; END OF STRIKE POSSIBLE." Robert sits on the sofa with a cup of coffee.

NATASHA
(beat)
The ethics consultant agrees with
you. (beat) Assent matters at
fourteen. (beat) And psychology
says he's depressed, not
confused. (beat) He understands
exactly what he's refusing.

ROBERT
(beat)
Amond thinks I'm being soft.

NATASHA
(beat, a small smile)
You are being soft. (beat) You've always been soft about hearts, Robert. (beat) It's the only thing you're soft about.

ROBERT
(beat)
He told me his father bled out holding his hand. (beat) I've known him five months. (beat) He's never told me anything.

NATASHA
(turning from the window)
Then he trusts you. (beat) Don't waste it on being right.

On the TV, footage of TWU President Roger Toussaint at a podium. Natasha turns up the volume slightly.

NATASHA
(beat, dry)
Camille Toussaint swears there's no relation.

ROBERT
(beat)
Daddy called. (beat) Your father. (beat) Brookline. (beat) Christmas Day dinner at four. (beat) Joan wants to know if Marc is coming or if he's "having Christmas with his roommates now."

NATASHA
(beat)
What did you tell him?

ROBERT
(beat)
I told him to ask Marc himself. (beat) He said he would. (beat) He said, "The boy doesn't lie to me, Robert. He just doesn't tell me things."

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 3 - MORNING

THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 11:04 AM

Earl, in the Santa sweatshirt, which he has refused to take off, lies in bed. Dorothy sits beside him. Raven checks the monitor and frowns. Heart rate one twenty-four. Pressure eighty-eight over fifty.

EARL
(pale, sweating)
I feel... (beat) Doc, I feel kind of funny.

RAVEN
(pressing his belly)
His belly's more distended. (beat) Mr. Peebles, look at me.

His eyes roll back. The monitor alarms: pressure seventy-four.

RAVEN
(to the nurse, fast)
Two large-bore IVs, wide open. (beat) Type and cross four units. (beat) Page Dr. Lowery. Stat. (beat) He's rebleeding.

DOROTHY
(standing, terrified)
Earl? Earl!

RAVEN
(beat, to Dorothy)
Mrs. Peebles, his spleen is bleeding again. (beat) He needs surgery. Now.

Lowery appears in the doorway, already pulling a cap over his white hair.

LOWERY
(calm)
OR 3. (beat) Dr. Ellison, you're with me.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 3 - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 11:29 AM

Earl's abdomen is open. Blood everywhere. Lowery packs the left upper quadrant with laps while Raven suctions. The anesthesiologist squeezes in blood.

LOWERY
(calm)
Mobilize the spleen. (beat) Dr. Ellison, your hand behind it. (beat) Lift it up into the wound.

Raven slides her hand behind the spleen, cradles it and lifts. Lowery clamps the hilum.

LOWERY
(beat)
Pressure?

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
Ninety. (beat) Coming up.

LOWERY
(dividing)
Splenectomy. (beat) He'll need pneumococcal, meningococcal and Hib vaccines before he goes home. (beat) And no more roofs.

RAVEN
(beat, softly)
His whole life is that roof, Dr. Lowery.

LOWERY
(beat)
His whole life is in your hand right now, Dr. Ellison. (beat) Concentrate on that one.

The spleen comes out into a basin. Raven looks at it: a purple, shattered thing the size of a fist.

RAVEN
(beat)
Forty-one thousand lights. (beat)
Twenty-two years.

LOWERY
(beat, not looking up)
Five o'clock, you said?

RAVEN
(beat)
Five o'clock.

LOWERY
(beat)
You're off at four-thirty. (beat)
Laurelton is twenty minutes by car. (beat) Penn Station is forty from Laurelton. (beat) You'd need a ride.

Raven looks at him over her mask. He keeps sewing.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - NEUROSURGERY - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 11:42 AM

Quentin Bascomb, his head shaved and pinned. Graves (52) at the head. Esther holds the drill. Marc suctions. On the light box, the CT shows a lens-shaped white blood clot on the left side, pressing the brain across the midline.

GRAVES
(calm)
Temporal craniotomy. (beat)
Middle meningeal artery. (beat)
Dr. Smilley, open.

The drill whines. The bone flap lifts. A thick, dark clot bulges out under pressure. Graves suctions it away. Bright arterial blood spurts from a torn vessel on the dura.

GRAVES
(beat)
There. (beat) Bipolar. (beat) Dr. Smilley.

Esther takes the bipolar and coagulates the bleeding artery. It stops. The brain, freed of the pressure, slowly settles back toward its normal position.

GRAVES
(beat, pleased)
Good. (beat) Epidurals are the most grateful hematomas in neurosurgery. (beat) Get them out fast and the patient goes back to work. (beat) Wait an hour, and they go to the morgue.

MARC
(beat)
He told me he had a nine o'clock.

GRAVES
(beat, dry)
He'll make his nine o'clock in January. (beat) On the 7 train, God willing.

Esther looks at Marc across the table. A small, private smile.

ESTHER
(beat)
I'm going to Boston tomorrow.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

ESTHER
(beat)
Malcolm will be at the table.

GRAVES
(beat, without looking up)
Dr. Smilley. (beat) Close the dura first. Then discuss Christmas.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PEDIATRIC CARDIOLOGY - ROOM 5 - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 11:58 AM

Kamari lies in bed with his headphones on, staring at the ceiling. Nadine has gone for coffee. The door opens. Raven wheels in Dash in a wheelchair, the milrinone pump hanging from an IV pole she's clamped to the chair. Dash wears his hoodie and a pair of pristine limited-edition sneakers.

DASH
(beat)
Those your Game Boy or your mama's?

Kamari takes off one headphone and looks at him.

KAMARI
(beat)
Who are you?

DASH
(beat)
Dash Duvall. (beat) Room 609. (beat) Dilated cardiomyopathy. (beat) Ejection fraction fifteen. (beat) 1A, six weeks.

Kamari takes off the other headphone.

KAMARI
(beat)
You're waiting for one.

DASH
(beat)
Every second. (beat) I can tell you exactly how many times the phone at the nurses' station has rung since November eleventh. (beat) Every time, I think it's for me.

KAMARI
(beat)
Then take mine.

DASH
(laughing softly)
It's not a sneaker, little man. You can't trade it. (beat) It's sized for you. Blood type, body weight. (beat) It's yours.

Kamari looks at the ceiling.

KAMARI
(beat)
I've been in the hospital every Christmas since I was nine.

DASH
(beat)
I've been in this one since October. (beat) Missed my mama's birthday. Missed my store's tenth anniversary. (beat) Kid, you know what I'd do with a heart? (beat) I'd be home in Charlotte by Easter. (beat) I'd sell a pair of these to some sixteen-year-old who'd saved up all summer, and I'd watch his face. (beat) That's all. (beat) That's my whole wish list.

Silence. Raven stands very still by the door.

KAMARI
(beat, barely)
What if it doesn't work?

DASH
(beat)
Then it doesn't. (beat) But you'll have tried. (beat) The other way, you just don't get to find out.

Kamari looks at Dash's sneakers.

KAMARI
(beat)
Those are the Christmas ones. (beat) There were only four thousand pairs.

DASH
(beat, grinning)
Size?

KAMARI
(beat)
Nine and a half.

DASH
(beat)
Get the heart. (beat) I'll have a pair shipped from Charlotte by the time they take your tubes out.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - VIP SUITE - 8 WEST - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 12:21 PM

The hour is over. The suite is full again. Freddie on the phone with the Apollo producer. Tamiko holds up the gown against Bernadine. Brother Oliver plays the opening of "O Holy Night" on the keyboard, and Bernadine, propped up, tries the first phrase. Her voice soars, then cracks. She doubles over. Harmony comes in at a run.

HARMONY
(sharp)
Everybody out. (beat) Now.

FREDDIE
(covering the phone)
Doctor, we were just...

HARMONY
(beat, in her big church voice)
OUT.

The room empties. Harmony goes to the bed. Bernadine is gray, sweating, rigid, her hands pressed to her upper belly.

BERNADINE
(gasping)
Like a knife. (beat) Right through to my back.

Harmony presses gently. The belly is board-hard. Bernadine screams.

HARMONY
(beat, grabbing the phone)
Page Dr. Lowery. (beat) Upright chest film, stat. (beat) I think she's perforated.

She hangs up and takes Bernadine's hand.

HARMONY
(beat, quietly)
I'm sorry, Lady Starks. (beat) I tried to keep it quiet.

BERNADINE
(through her teeth)
You did, baby. (beat) I'm the one who let them back in.

20 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 12:46 PM

A strike-day lunch crowd: nurses who've been sleeping at the hospital, doctors who walked over bridges. A plastic Santa on the bar. The TV shows Bloomberg at a podium, then the TWU hall. Monty (43) pours coffee. Marc and Amond eat at the bar. Cedric (40) sits at the end, sketching.

AMOND
(beat)
He thinks you can't save somebody who doesn't want to be saved.

MARC
(beat)
My father.

AMOND
Your father. (beat) Five hours, Marc. A heart has five hours. (beat) And he wants to spend them listening to a fourteen-year-old talk about Christmas.

MARC
(beat)
My grandfather thinks you can save anybody if you're good enough. (beat) That's why they don't get along.

MONTY
(wiping the bar)
Which one's right?

MARC
(beat)
Depends who's on the table.

Amond's pager goes off. He reads it. Something shifts in his face.

AMOND
(beat, standing, grabbing his coat)
He said yes. (beat) The kid said yes. (beat) Dash Duvall talked him into it.

MARC
(beat)
Dash?

AMOND
(beat, already at the door)
Your father was right, Marc. (beat) And I hate it.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 5 - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 1:52 PM

Bernadine under anesthesia. Lowery and Harmony at the table. In the duodenum, a round, punched-out hole the size of a pencil eraser, leaking bile.

LOWERY
(calm)
Anterior duodenal perforation. (beat) Dr. Divine, what do we do?

HARMONY
(beat)
Graham patch. (beat) Three sutures across the hole, a tongue of omentum laid on top, tie the sutures over it. (beat) Washout. (beat) Test for H. pylori, treat it, stop the aspirin.

LOWERY
(handing her the needle driver)
You did one on Brother Kareem in October. (beat) Do another.

Harmony places the sutures, brings a flap of omentum over the hole and ties them down. Gently. Perfect.

HARMONY
(beat, tying)
Her manager wants her singing at the Apollo tomorrow night.

LOWERY
(beat)
Her manager can sing at the Apollo tomorrow night.

Harmony laughs behind her mask.

LOWERY
(beat)
Dr. Divine. (beat) You threw a gospel star's entourage out of a VIP suite twice in one morning. (beat) Whose idea was that?

HARMONY
(beat)
Mine, sir.

LOWERY
(beat)
Good. (beat) Next time, throw them out at eight.

22 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ROOF - HELIPAD - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 2:38 PM

A cold, bright winter afternoon. A helicopter settles onto the pad, its rotors throwing up a storm of grit. A procurement coordinator in a jumpsuit jumps out with a red-and-white cooler marked "HUMAN ORGAN FOR TRANSPLANT." Robert and Amond, in scrubs and coats, wait at the edge of the pad.

Amond's phone buzzes in his pocket. He glances at it. A text from Marc.

SMS: "STRIKE IS OVER. TWU VOTED TO GO BACK. TRAINS TONIGHT."

Across the river, Manhattan glitters under a hard blue sky. Somewhere below, a city of seven million people is about to get its trains back. The coordinator hands Robert

the cooler.

COORDINATOR
(shouting over the rotors)
Cross-clamp at ten-fifty a.m.! (beat) You've got about two hours!

ROBERT
(to Amond, taking the cooler)
Dr. Baker. (beat) Let's go put a heart into a boy who wants one.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - CARDIAC - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 3:48 PM

Kamari on bypass, his chest open. His old heart is gone. In its place, the donor heart, pale and still, has been sewn in: left atrium, right atrium, aorta, pulmonary artery. Coltrane's "My Favorite Things" plays softly from Robert's boom box. Robert and Amond stand across from each other.

ROBERT
(calm)
Remove the cross-clamp.

The clamp comes off. Warm blood floods the new coronary arteries. The heart pinks up. A beat. Nothing. Then a flutter. Then fibrillation, a quivering mass.

AMOND
(beat)
V-fib.

ROBERT
(beat)
Internal paddles. Twenty joules.

Amond places the paddles on either side of the heart. Shock. The heart stops. A long, terrible second. Then it contracts. Once. Twice. A strong, regular beat.

AMOND
(barely)
It's beating.

ROBERT
(beat, watching it)
It's beating.

For a moment, neither of them says anything. The heart beats in the boy's chest. "My Favorite Things" plays on.

ROBERT
(beat, quietly)
Thank you for waiting, Dr. Baker.

AMOND
(beat, not looking up)
I didn't wait. (beat) Dash Duvall did. (beat) For six weeks.

ROBERT
(beat)
And you were in that room. (beat) You saw what made the difference. (beat) It wasn't us.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 4:07 PM

Tamika Wardell, out of her wheelchair, stands with one hand through the porthole of Aaliyah's isolette. Andre beside her. Arianna checks Devin's silo. Crump watches from the doorway.

TAMIKA
(beat)
Dr. Cummings. (beat) The stockings. (beat) Did you do these?

ARIANNA
(beat)
The night nurses. (beat) I did the glitter.

TAMIKA
(beat, smiling)
You did the glitter.

ARIANNA
(beat, gruff)
I'm good with glitter. (beat) Don't tell anybody.

Tamika takes a fifth stocking out of her pocket: tiny, red felt, the name "ELIJAH" stitched in white thread. Her hands are shaking.

TAMIKA
(beat)
I made this one. (beat) Last night. (beat) I don't know where to put it.

Arianna looks at the stocking. Then she takes a strip of tape from her pocket and gently tapes it to the wall above the four isolettes, in the middle, where all of them can see it.

ARIANNA
(beat)
There.

Tamika covers her mouth. In the doorway, Crump straightens his bow tie and looks away.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SECURITY OFFICE - DAY
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 4:29 PM

Big Ray at his desk. Raven, in her coat, stands in front of him with Earl's house key in her hand.

RAVEN
(fast)
Ray. (beat) Laurelton. (beat) Two hundred and twenty-sixth Street. (beat) Forty-one thousand lights. (beat) Five o'clock. (beat) Then Penn Station at seven fifty-two. (beat) I'm in a carpool of one.

BIG RAY
(beat, not looking up)
Dr. Ellison. (beat) The security van is for hospital business.

RAVEN
(beat)
Earl Peebles is a patient of this hospital.

BIG RAY
(beat)
His Christmas lights are not.

Raven waits. Big Ray sighs, stands and takes his coat off the hook. He picks up the van keys.

BIG RAY
(beat, heavily)
My daughter used to make me drive her through Dyker Heights every Christmas Eve. (beat) Forty-five minutes in traffic to look at lawns. (beat) I complained every year. (beat) She's in Atlanta now. (beat) I'd give anything for that traffic.

RAVEN
(beat)
Thank you, Ray.

BIG RAY
(beat)
Don't thank me. (beat) If Dr. Donohue asks, it was a medical courier run.

26 EXT. THE PEEBLES HOUSE - LAURELTON, QUEENS - DUSK
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 4:58 PM

A modest brick house on a quiet street, covered from foundation to chimney in unlit wires, inflatable snowmen, plywood reindeer and a full nativity on the lawn. The one on the left is crooked. A small crowd has already gathered on the sidewalk: neighbors, kids in snowsuits, and a church bus from St. Albans idling at the curb with its doors open. Raven and Big Ray come up the driveway.

NEIGHBOR
(worried)
Where's Earl? (beat) It's almost five. (beat) Earl never misses five.

RAVEN
(beat)
Earl's at Queens Grace. (beat)
He's okay. (beat) He sent me.

She kneels at the outlet box by the garage, finds the master switch, the one with "EARL ONLY" written on masking tape, and takes out her phone. She dials.

RAVEN
(into the phone)
Mr. Peebles. (beat) It's Dr.
Ellison. (beat) Listen.

She flips the switch. Forty-one thousand lights blaze to life at once: white, red, green, gold. The roofline. The trees. The reindeer, still crooked. The crowd gasps and cheers. The kids scream. The church bus honks. Someone starts singing "Joy to the World."

EARL (V.O.)
(on the phone,
weak, sobbing)
I hear them. (beat) Dot, I hear
them.

Raven stands on the lawn in the blaze of light with the phone held up so he can hear the crowd. Big Ray, leaning on the van, wipes his eyes and pretends it's the cold.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 3 - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 5:12 PM

Earl, post-op, groggy, his Santa sweatshirt folded on the chair beside him. Dorothy holds the phone to his ear, still connected to Raven on the lawn. The crowd's singing comes faintly out of the receiver. Lowery stands at the foot of the bed with the chart.

EARL
(weak, crying)
Twenty-two years, Dot. (beat)
First time I didn't flip the
switch.

DOROTHY
(beat)
A doctor flipped it for you, Earl. (beat) A doctor.

Lowery writes in the chart. He doesn't look up.

LOWERY
(beat, dry)
Mr. Peebles. (beat) The reindeer on the left is still crooked. (beat) Dr. Ellison reports it from the scene.

EARL
(beat, laughing, then wincing)
Ow. (beat) Ow. (beat) I knew it.

LOWERY
(beat)
Next year, you hire a teenager for the roof. (beat) You stay on the ground and supervise. (beat) Doctor's orders.

EARL
(beat)
Yes, sir.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - VIP SUITE - 8 WEST - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 5:34 PM

Bernadine, post-op, pale, an NG tube taped to her nose, lies in the quiet suite. Only Yvonne is there now, reading. The rest of the entourage has gone. Harmony checks the drains.

BERNADINE
(hoarse)
I fired Freddie.

HARMONY
(startled)
You what?

BERNADINE
(beat)
Twenty-two years. (beat) While they were rolling me down the hall, I heard him on the phone telling the Apollo I'd be "fine for tomorrow." (beat) I was bleeding into my belly, and he was selling my voice. (beat) Yvonne called him at three. (beat) It's done.

YVONNE
(not looking up from the Bible)
Should have done it in '97.

BERNADINE
(beat, to Harmony)
Sing something, baby.

HARMONY
(beat)
Lady Starks, I'm your doctor.

BERNADINE
(beat)
And I'm your patient, and I haven't heard a song in this room all day that wasn't somebody selling something. (beat) Sing me something for free.

Harmony hesitates. Then, softly, in a rich, warm contralto, she sings the first verse of "This Christmas." Yvonne puts down the Bible. Bernadine closes her eyes, and a tear runs into her hairline. On the second verse, Bernadine joins in, weak and cracked, harmonizing an octave below. In the hallway, a nurse stops walking.

BERNADINE
(beat, when it ends)
Mahalia. (beat) You sound like a young Mahalia.

HARMONY
(beat, embarrassed)
People say that.

BERNADINE
(beat)
People say it because it's true. (beat) When I get out of here, you're coming to Bethel to sing with me. (beat) No Freddie. No cameras. (beat) Just church.

29 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - BEDROOM - NIGHT

THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 6:04 PM

Two suitcases open on the bed. Esther folds sweaters. Clayton stands at the dresser, holding a tie in each hand, frozen.

CLAYTON
(beat)
The gray or the burgundy?

ESTHER
(beat)
Clayton, it's my mother's house in Mattapan. (beat) Nobody wears a tie.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Malcolm will.

Esther stops folding.

CLAYTON
(beat)
He always wore one to your mother's. (beat) Since he was twelve. (beat) He told me once it was because she was the first person who ever treated him like he was worth dressing up for.

A long silence.

ESTHER
(beat, quietly)
Rule one. (beat) Nobody leaves the table. (beat) Not him, not you, not me. (beat) Whatever happens, we eat my mother's food and we stay in our chairs.

CLAYTON
(beat)
And rule two?

ESTHER
(beat)
There's no rule two. (beat) I couldn't think of one.

Clayton puts down both ties. He sits on the edge of the bed among the sweaters.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Burgundy.

ESTHER
(beat, almost smiling)
Burgundy.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 2 - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 6:42 PM

Kamari, intubated, sedated, his new heart beating steadily on the monitor. Nadine sits beside him holding his hand, her knitting in her lap. Amond adjusts a drip. Dash, in his wheelchair, his milrinone pump hanging from its pole, sits outside the glass door with Raven, who's just returned, still in her coat.

DASH
(watching through the glass)
Look at that. (beat) Sinus rhythm. (beat) Ninety-four. (beat) That's a good heart.

RAVEN
(beat)
You know what sinus rhythm is?

DASH
(beat)
Seven weeks on a monitor, Doctor. (beat) I could read an EKG before I could read a contract.

Nadine turns, sees Dash through the glass and gets up. She comes out, takes his face in both hands and kisses his forehead.

NADINE
(crying)
Thank you. (beat) Thank you.

DASH
(beat, embarrassed)
Ma'am, I just talked about sneakers.

NADINE
(beat)
You talked my son into living. (beat) I'm going to pray for your phone to ring every single night until it does.

She goes back inside. Dash watches her go. His grin falters.

DASH
(quietly, to Raven)
Every time it rings, I think it's mine.

RAVEN
(beat, her hand on his shoulder)
It's going to be yours, Dash.

DASH
(beat)
Don't promise me that, Dr. Ellison. (beat) You can't.

RAVEN
(beat)
I know. (beat) I'm promising anyway.

31 INT. PENN STATION - AMTRAK CONCOURSE - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 7:49 PM

The low-ceilinged, crowded Amtrak concourse at Christmas. A Salvation Army bell ringer. Travelers with shopping bags. The departure board flickers. "PALMETTO -- FROM SAVANNAH -- ARRIVED -- TRACK 9 E." Raven stands at the top of the escalator in her coat, a Santa hat crushed in her hands. Arianna stands a step behind her, hands in her pockets. Marc stands behind Arianna, at a careful distance.

Passengers rise up the escalator. A businessman. A family with three kids. A soldier in desert camouflage. Raven's breath is coming fast.

ARIANNA
(low)
Breathe, Ellison.

RAVEN
(barely)
What if I don't recognize her?

ARIANNA
(beat)
You will.

And then: a small, thin woman in a plain navy wool coat, a scarf over her hair, a Bible in one hand and a single suitcase in the other, rises slowly up the escalator. LORNA ELLISON (44). She has Raven's eyes. She looks older than forty-four. She reaches the top and stops, scanning the crowd, terrified.

Their eyes meet.

LORNA
(whispering)
Raven.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

32 INT. PENN STATION - AMTRAK CONCOURSE - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 7:52 PM

Neither of them moves. The crowd flows around them. Lorna sets down her suitcase. Her hands are shaking.

LORNA
(beat)
You're so tall. (beat) You got tall.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
I was this tall when I was twenty, Mama.

LORNA
(beat, crying)
I know. (beat) I don't remember twenty. (beat) That's the part I'm sorriest for. (beat) I don't remember you at twenty.

Raven crosses the last six feet and puts her arms around her mother. Lorna holds her like she's afraid she'll evaporate. They stand like that in the middle of Penn Station, rocking, while the Salvation Army bell rings.

Behind them, Arianna turns away and wipes her face with her sleeve. Marc puts a hand on her shoulder. She doesn't shake it off.

ARIANNA
(thick)
I said I wasn't hugging anybody.

MARC
(beat)
You're not hugging anybody.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Good.

33 INT. LIRR TRAIN - TO HUNTERSPOINT AVENUE - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 8:31 PM

A rattling LIRR car heading out of the tunnel into Queens. Lorna sits by the window, watching the lights of Long Island City. Raven sits beside her, holding her hand. Arianna and Marc sit across the aisle.

LORNA
(beat, looking at the skyline)
I never thought I'd see New York. (beat) I never thought I'd see you again, period.

RAVEN
(beat)
Mama. (beat) This is Marc. (beat) My roommate. My best friend. (beat) It's his house.

LORNA
(beat, solemnly offering her hand)
Thank you for taking care of my daughter, Marc.

MARC
(beat)
Ma'am, she takes care of me.

RAVEN
(beat, turning to Arianna)
And this is Arianna. (beat) Arianna Cummings. (beat) She's... (beat) She's mine, Mama.

A long beat. Lorna looks at Arianna. Arianna looks back, braced, her jaw set, the way she's braced for every adult in her life.

LORNA
(beat, gently)
In the program, they teach you that you don't get to have opinions about other people's lives until you've cleaned up your own. (beat) I'm three years into cleaning up mine. (beat) But I've got one opinion. (beat) You came to the train station with my daughter on a cold night. (beat) Thank you, Arianna.

Arianna can't speak. She nods. The train pulls into Hunterspoint Avenue.

34 INT. CANARSIE ROW HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 9:04 PM

The cousin's crowded living room, a small tinsel tree on top of the TV. Augustin Toussaint (64), in his gray suit, sits on the folded couch. Camille sits beside him. A small, flat gift box, wrapped in newspaper, lies on his lap.

CAMILLE
(beat)
It's not much, Papa.

He unwraps it slowly. Inside: a framed photo, faded, of the Hotel Toussaint on Esplanade in its glory in the 1970s, a young Augustin in a white suit at the door, a little girl with braids on his shoulders.

AUGUSTIN
(beat, very quiet)
Where did you find this?

CAMILLE
(beat)
The Times-Picayune archives. (beat) I called a man at Tulane for three weeks.

Augustin holds it for a long time. Then he reaches into his breast pocket and takes out a small velvet pouch. He

puts it in her hand. Inside: a crystal rosary with a silver crucifix.

AUGUSTIN
(beat)
Your mother's. (beat) It was in my pocket at the cemetery on the Friday before the storm. (beat) It's the only thing of hers I carried out.

CAMILLE
(barely)
Papa.

AUGUSTIN
(beat, not looking at her)
I meant what I said in the chapel, Camille. (beat) I don't know how to be a man who is all right with it. (beat) But I know that she would want you to have this. (beat) And that is all I know tonight.

Camille holds the rosary. Augustin holds the photo. They sit side by side on the couch under the tinsel tree, not touching.

35 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 9:21 PM

The front door opens. Raven brings her mother inside. The tree is now fully decorated, eleven boxes' worth, glowing. Harmony and Amond stand in the hallway. Mercy, the puppy, skids across the floor and sniffs Lorna's shoes.

LORNA
(beat, staring at the tree)
Oh, my Lord.

RAVEN
(beat, nervous)
I might have overdone it.

Lorna walks slowly to the tree. Near the top, a little lopsided, hangs a construction-paper star with a school photo glued in the middle: a gap-toothed girl of about seven with pigtails. Lorna reaches up and touches it.

LORNA
(whispering)
Pulaski Elementary. (beat) First grade. (beat) I remember this one. (beat) You made it the year before your grandmother took you. (beat) You hung it on the bathroom door because we didn't have a tree.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
Grandmother kept it. (beat) It was in her Bible when she died.

Lorna turns from the tree and looks at her daughter, really looks at her, the surgeon in the house with eleven boxes of ornaments.

LORNA
(beat)
You made a home, baby. (beat) Out of nothing. (beat) Just like her.

Harmony, in the hallway, takes Amond's hand without thinking about it. Amond, astonishingly, lets her.

36 INT. THE DIVINE HOUSE - CAMBRIA HEIGHTS - KITCHEN - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 9:48 PM

Howard, back from the picket line, sits at the kitchen table in his MTA parka, eating a plate of leftovers. Lillian washes the coffee urns. The TV on the counter shows NY1: "TRAINS AND BUSES RETURNING TONIGHT; FULL SERVICE BY MORNING."

LILLIAN
(beat)
Six days' pay, Howard. (beat)
Three days out, two days' fine
for each one.

HOWARD
(beat, eating)
I know.

LILLIAN
(beat)
Was it worth it?

Howard puts his fork down. He thinks about it honestly.

HOWARD
(beat)
They wanted the new men to pay
six percent toward their
pensions, Lil. (beat) The young
ones. The ones who'll be driving
the Q4 when I'm gone. (beat)
Somebody stood up for me in 1974.
(beat) So yes. (beat) It was
worth it.

He coughs. Lillian turns from the sink and watches him. It passes. He picks up his fork.

HOWARD
(beat, smiling)
I'm driving the six-fifteen out
of Queens Village tomorrow
morning. (beat) Somebody's got to
take those people to work.

37 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BREAK ROOM - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 10:07 PM

Kennerly sits alone with a vending-machine sleeve of peanut butter crackers. Gloria comes in with her coat on, finally going home on the first night the trains are back. She sets a small red envelope on the table in front of him and a foil-wrapped plate beside it.

GLORIA
(beat)
From Lillian Divine. (beat) She dropped it at the desk on her way to the picket line this morning.

Kennerly opens the envelope. A drugstore Christmas card, a nativity scene. Inside, in round church-lady cursive: "Merry Christmas, baby. Eat a vegetable. -Mrs. D."

KENNERLY
(beat, barely)
She did it again.

GLORIA
(beat, buttoning her coat)
She'll keep doing it until you stop looking hungry. (beat) Merry Christmas, Dr. Kennerly.

KENNERLY
(beat, not looking up from the card)
Merry Christmas, Nurse Pettiford.

She goes. He peels back the foil. Collard greens. He picks up a fork.

38 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 10:26 PM

Robert, still in his coat, sits at the kitchen island with a glass of sparkling water. Natasha comes in. A wrapped present sits on the counter, addressed in her handwriting: "MARC."

NATASHA
(beat)
The heart?

ROBERT
(beat)
Sinus rhythm. (beat) Ninety-four. (beat) He'll be extubated tomorrow.

NATASHA
(sitting beside him)
And Amond?

ROBERT
(beat)
He said "thank you for waiting" to me in the OR. (beat) Except he said it like I'd asked him to hold my coat while I punched somebody.

Natasha laughs.

ROBERT
(beat, quieter)
I was wrong about him, Tasha. (beat) In July. (beat) I thought he was a machine. (beat) He's the most frightened brave person I've ever trained.

NATASHA
(beat)
And Marc? (beat) Brookline? (beat) Christmas Day?

ROBERT
(beat)
Marc's coming to Brookline. (beat) With the dog. (beat) Your mother said, "I'll have Cornelius find a dog bed," as though Cornelius has ever found a dog bed.

TAG

39 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 11:41 PM

The house is dark except for the tree. Lorna has gone up to the spare room. Raven lies on her back on the living room floor, under the tree, looking up through the branches at the lights. Marc comes downstairs, sees her, and lies down beside her without a word. Then Harmony, in her robe, lies on Raven's other side. Then Mercy, the puppy, trots over and flops down on Raven's stomach.

HARMONY
(beat, looking up)
What are we doing?

RAVEN
(beat)
When I was little, at my grandmother's, we didn't have a tree. (beat) So I'd lie under the Christmas lights at the church on Jefferson Street and look up. (beat) It looks like you're inside something good.

They lie there, the three of them and the dog, looking up at the lights.

MARC (V.O.)
Christmas in New York is supposed to be a postcard.

MARC
(beat, quietly)
Rave. (beat) Your mother's upstairs.

RAVEN
(beat, whispering)
My mother's upstairs.

40 EXT. THE PEEBLES HOUSE - LAURELTON, QUEENS - NIGHT
THURSDAY, DECEMBER 22, 2005 - 11:56 PM

The house still blazes with forty-one thousand lights on the empty street. A hand-lettered cardboard sign has been

staked in the lawn by a neighbor: "EARL'S IN THE HOSPITAL. HE SAYS MERRY CHRISTMAS. PRAY FOR HIS SPLEEN." On the lawn, the reindeer on the left is still crooked.

MARC (V.O.)
But a postcard doesn't show you who stayed up until five putting up the lights. (beat) Or who drove the van. (beat) Or who waited at the top of an escalator not knowing if she'd recognize the person coming up.

A single car slows to look, then drives on.

MARC (V.O.)
The postcard is just the outside. (beat) The inside is what people do for each other when nobody's taking a picture.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x12

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

THE NEW YORK TIMES: "TRANSIT WORKERS END STRIKE; SERVICE TO RESUME TONIGHT"

Thursday, December 22, 2005 (web edition)

"The leaders of the city's transit workers union voted this afternoon to send its members back to work, ending a three-day strike that shut down the subways and buses and forced millions of New Yorkers to walk, bike and carpool across the bridges in the cold... Contract talks are to continue."

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS: "WALK THIS WAY" (Tuesday) / "$1M A DAY" (Wednesday)

December 20-21, 2005

"Mayor Bloomberg denounced the walkout as 'illegal' and 'selfish'... State Supreme Court Justice Theodore Jones fined the Transport Workers Union $1 million a day, and under the Taylor Law each striker loses two days' pay for every day off the job... Cars entering Manhattan below 96th Street must carry at least four people."

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Thursday, December 22, 2005, 6:20 PM

"STRIKE OVER, MIRACLES ON. A 14-year-old got a heart today. Sources say a certain transplant patient on Six (yes, the haircut one) wheeled himself downstairs, IV pole and all, and talked the kid into it with a pair of sneakers. We are not crying, you are crying. Also: a gospel legend's manager was escorted out of a VIP suite by an intern who sings. Also also: someone saw the security van at the Laurelton Christmas House at 5 PM. Big Ray says it was 'a courier run.' Sure, Ray." Comments (1,903).

Cardboard sign on the Peebles lawn, Laurelton

Thursday, December 22, 2005

"EARL'S IN THE HOSPITAL. HE SAYS MERRY CHRISTMAS. PRAY FOR HIS SPLEEN."

Christmas card: Lillian Divine to Dr. Bryce Kennerly

Left at the ER desk, December 22, 2005

"Merry Christmas, baby. Eat a vegetable. -Mrs. D."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Marc Bullock to Amond Baker)

Thursday, December 22, 2005, 2:38 PM

Marc: "STRIKE IS OVER. TWU VOTED TO GO BACK. TRAINS TONIGHT."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x12

New Canon Established

- **LORNA ELLISON'S ON-SCREEN DEBUT** (44). She arrived at Penn Station on the Palmetto from Savannah at 7:52 PM. It was the first time Raven had seen her in six years ('I don't remember you at twenty'). Arianna and Marc were there. On the LIRR to Hunterspoint Avenue, **Raven introduced Arianna as 'mine,'** and Lorna thanked Arianna. Lorna is staying in the spare room through Christmas. **New canon:** Raven's grandmother, who raised her from about age 8, has died; she kept Raven's first-grade Pulaski Elementary paper star in her Bible, and it now tops the 49th Avenue tree. Raven lay under the church lights on Jefferson Street as a child.
- **The Grey's 2x12 beats:** Raven decorated the house from 2 to 5 AM (eleven boxes of ornaments; a Fraser fir). **Under the tree:** Raven, Marc, Harmony and Mercy lay on the living room floor at 11:41 PM. Earl Peebles, of the 'Laurelton Christmas House' (41,000 lights, 22 years), fell 14 feet while fixing a crooked reindeer. A grade III splenic laceration failed nonoperative management, and Lowery and Raven did a splenectomy. **Raven and Big Ray flipped his lights on at 5 PM** in the security van (logged as a 'courier run') while Earl listened by phone.
- **Kamari Fields** (14), with a failing Fontan (palliated at age four, six surgeries), **refused a heart.** Robert and Amond split over it. Robert: 'It only works in somebody who's willing to live with it.' Amond: 'I don't do slow.' **Amond told Robert his father bled out holding his hand**, the first personal thing he's told him. **Dash Duvall wheeled himself down and talked Kamari into it**, promising a pair of size 9.5 limited-edition Christmas sneakers. The heart came by helicopter from Pennsylvania (cross-clamp 10:50 AM); Robert and Amond transplanted it. Robert later said Amond is 'the most frightened brave person I've ever trained.' Kamari's mother Nadine prays for Dash's phone to ring.
- **Lady Bernadine Starks**, a gospel star with four Grammys and eleven Stellar Awards, had a bleeding duodenal ulcer from her tour, Goody's powders and her entourage. **Harmony threw the entourage out twice**, but the ulcer perforated anyway, and Harmony did a Graham patch under Lowery (her second, after Brother Kareem). Bernadine **fired her manager of 22 years, Freddie Lyle**, for telling the Apollo she'd be 'fine for tomorrow.' Harmony sang 'This Christmas' for her, and Bernadine has invited her to sing at Bethel.
- **The TWU strike** (December 20-22, real): Howard picketed at Queens Village Depot and Lillian fed the line. Howard loses six days' pay under the Taylor Law: 'Somebody stood up for me in 1974.' He drives the 6:15 AM run on December 23. Natasha joked that Camille swears she's no relation to Roger Toussaint. QGH ran carpool vans (Dr. Rountree's discretionary fund), and 22 nurses slept in the hospital. Esther and Kennerly walked the Pulaski Bridge; Kennerly biked from Carroll Gardens. Kennerly's father is in Scottsdale with his third wife. Kennerly got Lillian's second plate, with a Christmas card.
- **Augustin gave Camille her mother's crystal rosary** (the one thing of hers he carried out). Camille gave him a framed 1970s photo of the Hotel Toussaint on Esplanade, found through a Tulane contact. Augustin: 'I don't know how to be a man who is all right with it.' No reconciliation, but it is grace.

- **Esther and Clayton leave for Mattapan on December 23** (Amtrak). Esther's rule one: 'Nobody leaves the table.' Clayton will wear the burgundy tie, because Malcolm always wears a tie to Corinne's. **Marc is going to Brookline for Christmas Day dinner at 4**, with Mercy. Joan asked Cornelius to 'find a dog bed.' Natasha has a wrapped gift for Marc.
- **Amond's Grand Rounds (December 20):** he read Ms. Tate-Moore's triage note aloud and asked the 41 residents to stand if they'd ever seen a home-medication form. Nobody stood. Whitlow said 'Thank you, Dr. Baker' and left before the questions. Arianna's Step 2 score is due around January 4. She did the glitter on the quints' stockings and taped up Tamika's handmade 'ELIJAH' stocking. Harmony held Amond's hand in the hallway, and he let her. Elxa is at 33 weeks.

Knowledge Tracker (as of December 22, 2005)

Item	Who knows
Raven and Arianna are together	Now including Lorna
Dash's role in Kamari's yes	Robert, Amond, Raven, Nadine, the blog
Raven's grandmother has died	The housemates, Lorna
Robert's 1981 affair (Delphine Ware) and Mariah	Still secret (not touched this episode)
Heir designation	Still secret

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Earl Peebles	11/30/1947 (58)	Grade III splenic laceration; delayed rebleed	Splenectomy (Lowery; Ellison)	Stable; post-splenectomy vaccines
Lady Bernadine Starks	3/8/1956 (49)	Bleeding duodenal ulcer (NSAIDs, stress), then perforation	EGD clip; Graham patch (Lowery; Divine)	Recovering
Kamari Fields	4/24/1991 (14)	Failing Fontan circulation	Orthotopic heart transplant (R. Bullock; Baker)	Sinus rhythm; extubation December 23
Quentin Bascomb	1/29/1974 (31)	Left temporal epidural hematoma (cyclist vs. cab)	Craniotomy and evacuation (Graves; Smilley; Bullock)	Expected full recovery
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	8/8/1971 (34)	Status 1A, day 41	Continuous milrinone	Waiting

New Characters

- **Lorna Ellison** (on-screen debut). **Earl** (b. November 30, 1947) and **Dorothy Peebles** (b. June 18, 1949) of 226th Street, Laurelton. **Lady Bernadine Starks** (b. March 8, 1956), her sister **Yvonne** (b. April 11, 1960), **Freddie Lyle** (b. July 7, 1953, now fired) and **Brother Oliver Pettway** (b. October 2, 1961).

- **Kamari Fields** (b. April 24, 1991) and his mother **Nadine** (b. August 1, 1967), a TWU station agent. **Quentin Bascomb** (b. January 29, 1974), a Wall Street analyst who bought a bike for the strike.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- The TWU Local 100 strike ran from 3 AM Tuesday, December 20, to Thursday, December 22, 2005, when the union's executive board voted to return to work; service resumed that night and was fully restored by Friday morning. Justice Theodore Jones fined the union $1 million a day, the Taylor Law penalty is two days' pay per strike day, and carpools of four were required to enter Manhattan below 96th Street. A key issue was the MTA's proposal that new hires contribute more toward pensions. TWU Local 100's president was Roger Toussaint. People walked the Brooklyn, Queensboro, Williamsburg and Pulaski bridges. The LIRR and Amtrak kept running, and the LIRR serves Hunterspoint Avenue in LIC. The Palmetto runs between Savannah and New York.
- Medicine: hemodynamically stable grade III splenic injuries without contrast blush are often managed nonoperatively, but they can rebleed and need splenectomy, followed by vaccination against encapsulated organisms. NSAID and aspirin use (including Goody's powders) and H. pylori cause peptic ulcers, and perforation is repaired with a Graham omental patch. A failing Fontan is an indication for heart transplant, and the leading cause of late graft loss in adolescents is nonadherence. Donor heart ischemic time is ideally under four to six hours. An epidural hematoma (often from the middle meningeal artery) classically shows a lucid interval and needs emergent evacuation.